

Gig Economy Resources

Driving, delivery, freelancing, or selling online? You're running a business — and there's help to do it smarter, save on taxes, and grow. Below are trusted national resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

As a gig worker you're self-employed, which means taxes and benefits work differently. The resources below help you keep more money and protect yourself.

1 Handle Taxes the Right Way

Self-employment taxes trip up many gig workers — these make it manageable.

☐ IRS — Gig Economy Tax Center

Official guidance on taxes, deductions, and quarterly payments for gig workers.

→ www.irs.gov/businesses/gig-economy-tax-center

☐ Track Deductions

Mileage, supplies, phone, and home office can lower your taxes. The IRS center explains what counts.

→ www.irs.gov/businesses/small-businesses-self-employed/deducting-business-expenses

2 Get Affordable Benefits

You can get health coverage and save for retirement on your own.

☐ Health Coverage (HealthCare.gov)

Self-employed people often qualify for subsidized health plans.

→ www.healthcare.gov/self-employed/coverage

☐ Self-Employed Retirement (SEP-IRA / Solo 401k)

Tax-advantaged retirement accounts built for self-employed people.

→ www.irs.gov/retirement-plans/retirement-plans-for-self-employed-people

3 Grow & Formalize

Turn gig income into a real, protected business.

☐ Consider an LLC

Forming an LLC can protect you and look more professional. See the First Legal Steps guide.

→ See: **First Legal Steps** guide

☐ Free Business Mentoring

SCORE mentors help freelancers and gig workers grow and stabilize income.

→ www.score.org

4 Find Gig & Freelance Work

Trusted places to find clients and gigs.

☐ CareerOneStop — Self-Employment

Government resources for freelancers and the self-employed.

→ www.careeronestop.org/ExploreCareers/Plan/self-employment.aspx

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Set aside about 25–30% of gig income for taxes and pay quarterly — many new gig workers get a nasty surprise at tax time. The IRS Gig Center explains exactly how.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Track every work expense from day one (a free app or simple spreadsheet works). Deductions can cut your tax bill significantly — but only if you have records.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national resources. For local freelancer support and state tax rules, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
